

You Are Not Behind

Nobody told you what becoming a therapist would feel like.

THE IDEA

You can officially be the therapist before you feel like the therapist. Your title changes on a specific day, but your sense of yourself as someone who can do this work develops slowly, through experience. The gap between those two things is uncomfortable, and it is easy to mistake that discomfort for proof that you are unqualified. It isn't.

WHY IT FEELS SO PERSONAL

Therapy uses you: your attention, your tone, your comfort with emotion. So when something feels awkward, it doesn't feel like a skill you're still learning. It feels like something is wrong with you. A client goes quiet and you conclude "I'm boring" instead of "I'm still learning how to work with silence." That is a learning moment being turned into a verdict about your worth.

YOU'RE FURTHER ALONG THAN IT FEELS

The shift is quiet, not dramatic. You notice you're less desperate to fill every silence. You recover faster when a session feels awkward. You can hear feedback without collapsing. You can say "I'm not sure yet, let's slow down." Those are the signs the role is becoming yours.

ASK YOURSELF

Instead of "why don't I feel like a real therapist yet?" ask "what part of this role am I still learning to inhabit?" The first question has no answer. The second one gives you somewhere to practice.

The role can become yours before it feels familiar.